

Pavel Golikov

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

AI Researcher specializing in machine reasoning and alignment. Blends formal logic with rigorous low-level systems engineering to architect custom agentic frameworks and highly creative adversarial evaluations. Former Military Intelligence Operator who formerly held a Top Secret clearance, bringing a rigorous, threat-modeling mindset to AI security and model capability evaluations.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++, Java, SQL, LaTeX

ML & AI: PyTorch, vLLM, HuggingFace, Transformers, Google/Anthropic/OpenAI APIs, Agent Harness

Systems & Infrastructure: Linux/Ubuntu Server, AWS, Apache Flink, Distributed GPU Clusters

Core Competencies: Large Language Models (LLMs), Machine Reasoning, AI Alignment, Context Management, Mechanistic Interpretability, Adversarial Evaluations, Threat Modeling, Distributed Systems

FIRST-AUTHOR AI RESEARCH

- **ArbiGraph** | [arXiv](#) | [GitHub](#) 2026 – Present
 - Built **ArbiGraph**, a Python evaluation framework for testing whether LLM agents can follow long, multi-step workflows without losing, mixing up, or reusing stale intermediate state.
 - Converted math, word-problem, and Python-tracing tasks into automatically generated workflows with executable ground truth, enabling exact grading without manual labels.
 - Added controls for workflow length, branching, irrelevant distractors, and value types, letting researchers reproduce agent failure modes and scale difficulty without hand-crafting prompts.
 - Implemented the agent evaluation harness around a calculator tool, including answer extraction, tool-call validation, continuation handling, and repair prompts for incomplete or malformed runs.
- **Robust Reasoning Benchmark (RRB)** | [arXiv](#) | [DOI](#) | [GitHub](#) 2026
 - Designed a highly creative adversarial evaluation framework leveraging 13 deterministic textual perturbations to decouple an LLM’s mechanical deciphering from its underlying mathematical logic.
 - Demonstrated that the attention drift occurs *within a single query’s Chain-of-Thought*, empirically showing that intermediate reasoning steps pollute the dense attention mechanism, identifying the optimal **granularity of reasoning** as a critical open research problem.
 - Engineered custom mechanistic interpretability pipelines in **PyTorch** for layerwise attention-allocation analysis across token index boundaries, testing models ranging from 7B to 30B parameters.
- **Fusing Adds and Shifts for Efficient Dot Products** | [IEEE CAL](#) | [GitHub](#) 2026
Hardware ML Research Toronto, ON
 - Proposed and validated a novel algorithmic optimization for dot-product computations, demonstrating a strong foundational understanding of hardware-level ML primitives and efficiency.

ENGINEERING & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Systems & Infrastructure Engineering (MSc Thesis)** 2020 – 2022
University of Toronto Toronto, ON
 - Engineered a flexible IoT distributed data-streaming framework from scratch, designed to automatically partition computational streaming queries between edge devices and cloud instances.
 - Built the full software stack: programmed Arduino/C++ sensors for real-time biological data collection (EMG/ECG), developed custom socket networking protocols, and deployed cloud infrastructure using **AWS** and **Apache Flink**.
- **Intelligence Operator** 2013 – 2018
Canadian Armed Forces Canada
 - Formerly held a **Top Secret** security clearance while conducting rigorous analysis of classified information streams to produce actionable intelligence reports for command elements.
 - Developed a strong adversarial threat-modeling mindset, emphasizing operational security, rigorous data validation, and the identification of logical vulnerabilities in complex, multi-agent scenarios.
- **Mathematics Teacher** 2012 – 2013 & 2018 – 2019
Blyth Academy Toronto
 - Taught foundational mathematics to students in Grades 10, 11, and 12, developing the ability to distill and communicate complex quantitative concepts.

EDUCATION

- **University of Toronto** Toronto, ON
- **PhD in Computer Science (Paused to transition to industry)** 2022 – Present
- **University of Toronto** Toronto, ON
- **Master of Science (MSc) in Computer Science** 2020 – 2022
- **University of Toronto** Toronto, ON
- **Bachelor of Science (BSc) in Mathematics and Philosophy (Formal Logic)** Graduated 2011